

Definitions for the Area Health Resources Files Clinician Dashboard

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The Area Health Resources Files (AHRF) Clinician Dashboard provides county- and state-level counts and provider-to-population ratios of selected health professions in the United States. The AHRF Clinician Dashboard offers users flexibility to visualize and download data for health professions. The data included in the Dashboard are a subset from the full public use AHRF county-level and national/state-level data files (hereafter referred to as the “AHRF data files”). The AHRF data files and technical documentation are available for download in the HRSA Data Warehouse website (<https://data.hrsa.gov/data/download?data=AHRF#AHRF>).

AHRF Clinician Dashboard

Underlying Data

The county-level and national/state-level AHRF data included in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard are created using different data sources. Therefore, the sum of county-level data does not equal the counts from the national/state-level data file. The table below summarizes the data source for each level and type of data included in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard. Further details can also be found in the “Additional Information” sections in this document.

Level of Data	Type of Data	Data Source
County	Health Profession	American Medical Association (AMA) Physician Professional Data
		American Dental Association (ADA) Year-End Master File
		Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services National Provider Identification (CMS NPI) file
	Population	Various U.S. Census Bureau datasets
State	Health Profession	U.S. Census Bureau’s American Community Survey 5-Year Public Use Microdata Sample (ACS 5-Year PUMS)
	Population	

The AHRF county-level and national/state-level data files are released annually by the Bureau of Health Workforce. The release year for AHRF data files corresponds to the fiscal year (October 1 to September 30) when the data was developed. For each release, the included years of county- and state-level data can vary depending on the data availability and data use agreements for each data source. For example, the 2024-2025 AHRF release includes county-level physician and dentist data through 2023 (from 2023 AMA and ADA), county-level Nurse Practitioner data through 2024 (from CMS NPI), county-level total population data through 2024 (from Census datasets), and state-level health profession and population data through 2023 (from the ACS 5-Year PUMS).

Geographic Unit Change for the State of Connecticut

In 2022, [OMB](#) adopted the state of Connecticut’s nine planning regions as county-equivalent geographic units for purposes of collecting, tabulating, and disseminating statistical data, replacing the eight

counties. Data sources from the U.S. Census Bureau are or will use the nine new county-equivalent boundaries, names, and codes by their 2024 datasets. However, other data sources in the AHRF still use the eight counties. The AHRF data files report data according to the original source's county/county-equivalent designation for the state of Connecticut. FIPS codes for both the eight counties and nine planning regions are included in the AHRF to accommodate the differences.

Data Availability

In 2025, the AHRF Clinician Dashboard adopted the nine county-equivalent geographic units for Connecticut. As a result, the Dashboard only displays data that are available for the nine planning regions. Users can find the available Connecticut data for the eight counties in the AHRF data files from the HRSA Data Warehouse.

The AHRF Clinician Dashboard displays health profession and population data from the AHRF data files by calendar year, not release year. Some types of data in a calendar year may not be available due to their unavailability from the underlying data source or the change in county designations for Connecticut. The table below summarizes the level and type/source of data available for each calendar year in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard:

Calendar Year	Level of Data	Type/Source of Data	Availability
2024	County	Physicians and Dentists/from AMA and ADA	No
		Physician Assistants and Nurses/from CMS NPI	Yes
		Population/Census	Yes (total population only)
	State	All Health Professions/from ACS 5-Year PUMS	No
		Population/from ACS 5-Year PUMS	No
2023	County	Physicians and Dentists/AMA and ADA	Yes (except physicians in CT)
		Physician Assistants and Nurses/CMS NPI	Yes (except for CT)
		Population/Census	Yes
	State	All Health Professions/from ACS 5-Year PUMS	Yes
		Population/from ACS 5-Year PUMS	Yes
2022	County	Physicians and Dentists/AMA and ADA	Yes (except for CT)
		Physician Assistants and Nurses/CMS NPI	Yes (except for CT)
		Population/Census	Yes
	State	All Health Professions/from ACS 5-Year PUMS	Yes
		Population/from ACS 5-Year PUMS	Yes
2021 and prior	County	Physicians and Dentists/AMA and ADA	Yes (except for CT)
		Physician Assistants and Nurses/CMS NPI	Yes (except for CT)
		Population/Census	Yes (except for CT)
	State	All Health Professions/ from ACS 5-Year PUMS	Yes
		Population/from ACS 5-Year PUMS	Yes

Clinician Rate (per 100,000 population)

The clinician rate used in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard is calculated as clinician count divided by the respective population. The result then is multiplied by 100,000.

Data Note

When data are not available or suppressed, it is shown in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard as NA (not applicable).

Additional Information: County-Level Data

County-level data for selected health professions and the U.S. population within the AHRF Clinician Dashboard come from various data sources.

Health Profession Data

County-level data come from the data sources indicated below.

- Physician data are from the AMA Physician Professional Data which provides information on education, training and professional certification for Doctors of Medicine (MD) and Doctors of Osteopathic Medicine (DO) in the 50 U.S. states, District of Columbia, Puerto Rico, the U.S. Virgin Islands and Guam.
- Dentist data are from ADA Year-End Master Files which includes a census of all professionally active dentists in the 50 U.S. states, District of Columbia, Puerto Rico, the U.S. Virgin Islands and Guam.
- Nurse and Physician Assistant data are from CMS NPI files. The CMS NPI file contains FOIA disclosable National Plan and Provider Enumeration System (NPPES) health care provider data for health care providers who have been assigned National Provider Identifiers (NPI), a unique identifier developed by CMS.

Only selected health professions from the AHRF county-level data file are included in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard. The table below summarizes the data sources and definitions for each county-level health profession type in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard.

Health Profession Type	Definition
Physicians	Physicians include all active and inactive physicians with or without classified major professional activity (unless specifically stated otherwise). Inactive Status includes physicians who are retired, semiretired, working part-time, temporarily not in practice, or not active for other reasons and indicated they worked 20 hours or less per week. Not Classified Status includes physicians who did not provide information on their type of practice or their present employment. Federal Status is defined as full-time employment by the federal government, including the Army, Navy, Air Force, Veteran's Administration, the Public Health Service and other federally funded agencies. All physicians are stratified by active status and sex (male/female), and subgrouped by Doctor of Medicine (M.D.) and Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine (D.O.) physicians. All professions are specialties and/or subspecialties from the AHRF data files. The Primary Care profession includes General Family Medicine/Practice, General Practice, General Internal Medicine, and General Pediatrics specialties. Subspecialties within these specialties

	are excluded. The Total General Practice health profession includes the General Practice and General Family Medicine/Practice specialties and the Family Medicine/Practice Subspecialties.
Dentist	The Dentist profession includes professionally active dentists whose primary occupation is dental related. This includes Full-time and Part-time Private Practice; Dental School Faculty; Armed Forces; Other Federal Service; State or Local Government; Hospital Staff Dentist; Graduate Student/Resident; Other Health/Dental Organization Staff; and Part-Time Faculty/Part-Time Practice. Only those identified as active and licensed are included.
Physician Assistant	The Physician Assistant profession includes formally trained physician assistants who perform many of the routine, time-consuming tasks a physician can do. In some states, they may prescribe medications. They take medical histories, perform physical exams, order lab tests and x-rays, and give inoculations. Most states require that they work under the supervision of a physician.
Nurse	The Advanced Practice Registered Nurse (APRN) profession includes registered nurses having education beyond the basic nursing education and certified by a nationally recognized professional organization in a nursing specialty, or meeting other criteria established by a Board of Nursing. APRNs include advanced practice midwife, certified registered nurse anesthetist, clinical nurse specialist, and nurse practitioner. The Clinical Nurse Specialist profession includes registered nurses who, through a graduate degree program in nursing, or through a formal post-basic education program or continuing education courses and clinical experience, are experts in a specialty area of nursing practice within one or more of the components of direct patient/client care, consultation, education, research and administration. The Certified Registered Nurse Anesthetist (CRNA) profession includes licensed registered nurses with advanced specialty education in anesthesia who, in collaboration with appropriate health care professionals, provide preoperative, intraoperative, and postoperative care to patients and assist in management and resuscitation of critical patients in intensive care, coronary care, and emergency situations. A CRNA is qualified by special training to administer anesthesia in collaboration with a physician or dentist, and who can assist in the care of patients who are in critical condition. The Nurse Midwife profession includes both certified nurse-midwives (CNMs) and certified midwives (CMs). Midwifery practice is the independent management of women's health care, focusing particularly on pregnancy, childbirth, the post-partum period, care of the newborn, and the family planning and gynecologic needs of women. The CNM and CM practice within a health care system that provides for consultation, collaborative management, or referral, as indicated by the health status of the client. The Nurse Practitioner profession includes registered nurse providers with a graduate degree in nursing prepared for advanced practice involving independent and interdependent decision making and direct accountability for clinical judgment across the health care continuum or in a certified specialty. Nurse practitioner specialists include, but are not limited to, family nurse practitioners, gerontological nurse practitioners, pediatric nurse practitioners, obstetric-gynecologic nurse practitioners, and school nurse practitioners.

Population Data

County-level data for the U.S. population in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard come from the U.S. Census Bureau datasets indicated below.

- **Census County Population Estimates:** Each year, the Census Bureau's Population Estimates Program uses current data on births, deaths, and migration to calculate population change since the most recent decennial census and produces a time series of estimates of population, demographic components of change, and housing units.
- **Census County Characteristic File:** Each year, the Census Bureau produces and publishes estimates of the population for the nation, states, counties, state/county equivalents, and Puerto Rico. The county characteristic file provides estimates of states and counties by age, sex, race, and Hispanic origin
- **Census Small Area Income and Poverty Estimates (SAIPE):** The Census Bureau's SAIPE program provides annual estimates of income and poverty statistics for all school districts, counties, and states. It is designed to provide estimates of income and poverty for the administration of federal programs and the allocation of federal funds to local jurisdictions

Additional Information: State -Level Data

State-level data for selected health professions and the U.S. population within the AHRF Clinician Dashboard come from the U.S. Census Bureau's ACS 5-Year Public Use Microdata Sample (PUMS) Files.

- The ACS, an annual household survey, provides detailed self-reported data about U.S. households and persons, including information on individuals working across various industries and occupations. It is the major source of data for AHRF state-level data file.
- Health professions included are classified based on the U.S. government's 2018 Standard Occupational Classification (SOC) system.
- The "workforce" is defined as individuals aged 16+ who worked within the previous five years. Does not include individuals seeking employment for the first time and who have not yet secured their first job. All counts include 50 U.S. states and District of Columbia.
- For employed individuals, the occupation refers to the person's job during the previous week. For those who worked two or more jobs, the occupation refers to the job where the person worked the greatest number of hours (primary job).
- For unemployed individuals and those who are not currently employed but report having a job within the last five years, the data refer to their last job.
- ACS data are suppressed for any value where the percent relative standard error (PRSE) is greater than 30%. When data are suppressed, it is shown as NA (not applicable) in this dashboard application.

Health Profession Data

Only selected health professions from the AHRF national/state-level data file are included in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard. The table below summarizes the selected health professions and associated SOC codes from the ACS 5-Year PUMS.

Health Profession	SOC Code
Physician Assistants	29-1071
Registered Nurses	29-1141
Licensed Practical and Licensed Vocational Nurses	29-2061
Dental Hygienists	29-1292
Pharmacists	29-1051
Chiropractors	29-1011
Optometrists	29-1041
Psychologists	19-3033 Clinical and counseling psychologists 19-3034 School psychologists 19-303X Other psychologists ^a
Social Workers	21-1021 Child, family, and school social workers 21-1022 Healthcare social workers 21-1023 Mental health and substance abuse social workers 21-1029 Social workers, all other where NAICS industry code is "Medical Setting" and "Individual and Family Services": 6211, 6212, 62131, 62132, 6213ZM, 6214, 6216, 621M, 6222, 622M, 6231, 623M, 6241 ^b
Physical Therapists	29-1123
Occupational Therapists	29-1122
Respiratory Therapists	29-1126
Speech-Language Pathologists	29-1127
Dietitians and Nutritionists	29-1031
Emergency Medical Technicians and Paramedics	29-2042 Emergency medical technicians 29-2043 Paramedics

^a Includes 19-3032 (Industrial-Organizational Psychologists) and 19-3039 (Psychologists, All Other).

^b All work settings are derived from NAICS codes present in the ACS data files, which consist of either the original NAICS code or a composite or edited NAICS code (indicated by "Z", "M", and "P" suffixes).

Population Data

State-level data for the U.S. population in the AHRF Clinician Dashboard also come from ACS 5-Year PUMS files.